VII

Lessons for India

China's negotiating strategy and tactics have evolved as it moves towards the centre of the world stage. Strategies and tactics may vary depending on the situation and the relative strength of the two parties, as seen in the preceding chapters. But it is possible to discern the common threads that run through the way the Chinese deal with the outside world. Indian interlocutors may do well to remember these in preparing for talks with China.

Pre-Negotiation

Preparation of every aspect of the negotiations, both substance and protocol, is an essential part of the way the Chinese negotiate. Prior to any negotiations, the Chinese engage in meticulous preparation. This includes detailed knowledge of the subject at hand; and the careful study of available records of previous interactions on the subject, including those in the public archives of other nations. China's network of think-tanks